Persist Week of September 28, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
- Thursday, October 1st, 2026
- Friday, October 2nd, 2026
- Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
- Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
- Thursday, October 1st, 2026
- Friday, October 2nd, 2026
- Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
- Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
- Thursday, October 1st, 2026
- Friday, October 2nd, 2026

- Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
- Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Pump Condition 5x
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
- Thursday, October 1st, 2026
- Friday, October 2nd, 2026
- Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
- Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Pump Condition 4x
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
- Thursday, October 1st, 2026
- Friday, October 2nd, 2026
- Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
- Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Pump Condition 3x
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
- Thursday, October 1st, 2026
- Friday, October 2nd, 2026
- Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
- Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Perform
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
- Thursday, October 1st, 2026
- Friday, October 2nd, 2026
- Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
- Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Minimalist
- Monday, September 28th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026
Thursday, October 1st, 2026
Friday, October 2nd, 2026
Saturday, October 3rd, 2026
Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Deficit Deadlift Progression
The final deficit deadlift session of the cycle. Standing on a plate increases the range of motion through the bottom of the pull, demanding more from the hamstrings and glutes in the setup position. Reps are at their lowest this week, which means this should be the heaviest pulling work of the six weeks. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
3. Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Head Support Bent Over DB Row; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. DB Bent Over Meadows Row; 10-12 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90sec
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Arm Lean Away DB Shrug; 15 reps/side
rest 30 sec
2. Filly Carry; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press Progression

The final low incline dumbbell bench session of the cycle. The low incline angle sits just above flat, which keeps more demand on the mid chest while also targeting the upper chest. Reps drop further this week, which means this should be the heaviest dumbbell pressing work of the six weeks. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Seated Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
2. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
3. Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Barbell Preacher Curl; 15 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Cable Tricep Pushdown or Inverted Skullcrusher; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat comes back this week at 15 reps per set. The highest rep prescription of the cycle. High rep squats at RPE 7 to 9 demand both strength and the ability to sustain output under accumulated fatigue. Brace hard at the top of every rep before descending. The goal is to maintain consistent depth and speed across all three sets even as the legs accumulate fatigue.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
DB/KB Front Rack Front Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Poliquin Step; 10-15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Leg Raise or V Up; Perform 30-40 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8
4 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10/arm
- 15sec Single Leg Wall Sit/leg
- 15sec Planche Lean
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8
4 Sets
- 15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge R
- 15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge L
- 15sec Star Plank R
- 15sec Star Plank L
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):
30 min Mobility
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
2. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
3. Wrist Circles x 10
4. Downdog to Updog x 5
5. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
6. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
7. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
8. Crab Reach x 5/side
9. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
10. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
11. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
12. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
13. Reverse Nordics x 10

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip Progression
The final strict bar dip session of the cycle in a descending rep format: 5, 3, and 2 reps per set with RPE increasing across the two halves. The first three sets establish a moderate intensity baseline. The final three sets push into heavier or harder territory. As reps go down, the load goes up. Add weight or reduce assistance across the six sets. This is the heaviest dip work of the cycle.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
3. Prone Shoulder CARs; 5 SLOW reps
4. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your dips harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging dips. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm DB Row
Every 2:30 x 3 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 6 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean Away DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Cross Body Hammer Curl; 15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Walking Lunge
This is the final suitcase walking lunge of the cycle. Reps drop to six per side, so this should be your heaviest lunge work of the block. With a dumbbell in each hand at your sides, your grip and upper back have to work to keep you tall under the heavier load. Keep your torso upright and aim to beat Week 4 on every working set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps

3. DB Lateral Lunge; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Split Stance DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Arm Extended Plank; 15-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
2. Suitcase Single Leg Standing Calf Raise; 8-10 reps/side @31X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
The final low incline dumbbell bench session of the cycle. The low incline angle sits just above flat, which keeps more demand on the mid chest while also targeting the upper chest. Reps drop further this week, which means this should be the heaviest dumbbell pressing work of the six weeks. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side

3. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
2. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
3. Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Arm Lean Away DB Shrug; 15 reps/side
rest 30 sec
2. Filly Carry; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat Progression
The back squat comes back this week at 15 reps per set. The highest rep prescription of the cycle. High rep squats at RPE 7 to 9 demand both strength and the ability to sustain output under accumulated fatigue. Brace hard at the top of every rep before descending. The goal is to maintain consistent depth and speed across all three sets even as the legs accumulate fatigue.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
DB/KB Front Rack Front Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Poliquin Step; 10-15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Leg Raise or V Up; Perform 30-40 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
30 min Mobility
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
2. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
3. Wrist Circles x 10
4. Downdog to Updog x 5

5. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
6. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
7. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
8. Crab Reach x 5/side
9. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
10. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
11. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
12. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
13. Reverse Nordics x 10

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
The final strict bar dip session of the cycle in a descending rep format; 5, 3, and 2 reps per set with RPE increasing across the two halves. The first three sets establish a moderate intensity baseline. The final three sets push into heavier or harder territory. As reps go down, the load goes up. Add weight or reduce assistance across the six sets. This is the heaviest dip work of the cycle.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
3. Prone Shoulder CARs; 5 SLOW reps
4. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:

As reps go down, make your dips harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging dips. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 6 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean Away DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Cross Body Hammer Curl; 15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Deficit Deadlift Progression
This is the last deadlift of the cycle. Standing on a plate means you have to reach farther down to the bar, which makes your hamstrings and glutes work harder at the start. Reps are at their lowest this week, so this should be your heaviest pulling of all six weeks. Try to beat Week 4.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
3. DB Lateral Lunge; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Split Stance DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Arm Extended Plank; 15-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
2. Suitcase Single Leg Standing Calf Raise; 8-10 reps/side @31X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 Min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold
Run, Row or Bike

1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Upper Body Mobility
1. Shoulder Circles x 5/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
3. Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
4. Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
5. Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
6. Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
7. Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
8. Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
9. Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
10. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
11. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
12. Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can

handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat Progression
The back squat comes back this week at 15 reps per set. The highest rep prescription of the cycle. High rep squats at RPE 7 to 9 demand both strength and the ability to sustain output under accumulating fatigue. Brace hard at the top of every rep before descending. The goal is to hold consistent depth and speed across all three sets even as the legs fatigue.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
2. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
3. Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Arm Lean Away DB Shrug; 15 reps/side
rest 30 sec
2. Filly Carry; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):
30 min Full Body Mobility
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
2. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
3. Wrist Circles x 10 reps
4. Downdog to Updog x 5 reps
5. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
6. Prone Band Pass Through x 10 reps
7. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10 reps
8. Crab Reach x 5 reps/side
9. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
10. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
11. Pancake Stretch x 1 min/position
12. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
13. Reverse Nordics x 10 reps

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
The final low incline dumbbell bench session of the cycle. The low incline angle sits just above flat, placing more emphasis on the mid chest while also engaging the upper chest. Reps drop further this week, which means this should be the heaviest dumbbell pressing work of the six weeks. The set still finishes with a max unbroken drop set at Set 1 weight. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
DB/KB Front Rack Front Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Bent Over Row; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec
2. Rear Delt Swings; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Cross Body Hammer Curl; 15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
4. Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Deficit Deadlift
The final deadlift of the cycle. Standing on a plate means you reach farther down to the bar, which makes the hamstrings and glutes work harder off the floor. Reps are at their lowest this week, so this should be the heaviest pulling of all six weeks. Brace hard before each pull and try to beat Week 4.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
3. Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Poliquin Step; 10-15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Leg Raise or V Up; Perform 30-40 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Upper Body Mobility
1. Shoulder Circles x 5/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
3. Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
4. Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side

5. Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
6. Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
7. Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
8. Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
9. Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
10. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
11. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
12. Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Deficit Deadlift
This is the last deficit deadlift of the cycle. Standing on a plate lengthens the pull, so your hamstrings and glutes work harder from the very bottom. Reps are at their lowest this week, which means this should be your heaviest pulling of the block. Aim to beat what you did in Week 4 on every working set.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
3. Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):
3 Sets
12 Towel KB Curl
rest 15sec
12/side Alternating KB Gorilla Row
rest 15sec
6-8 KB Deadlift + 200ft KB Farmers Walk + 6-8 KB Deadlift
rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 26-35lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.

Effort Note:
Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press Progression
This is the last low incline dumbbell bench of the cycle. The slight incline keeps the work on your mid and upper chest while the dumbbells stay easy on your shoulders. Reps drop again this week, so this should be your heaviest dumbbell pressing of the block. Aim to beat Week 4 across all your working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworms
1min Plank DB Pull Through 50/35# (Male/Female)
15 DB Front Raise 25/15# (Male/Female)
1 min Overhead DB Carry 35/25# (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat Progression
The back squat finishes the cycle at fifteen reps per set, the highest reps of the block. High rep squats test your legs and your ability to keep pushing when tired. Brace hard at the top of every rep before you drop. The goal is the same depth and speed on rep fifteen as on rep one.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets

1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
12 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
12/9 Calorie Row (Male/Female)
6 Goblet Squat
rest 30sec
18 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
18/14 Calorie Row
9 Goblet Squat
rest 30sec
24 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
24/18 Calorie Row
12 Goblet Squat
rest 30sec
30 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)

30/24 Calorie Row
15 Goblet Squat
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8
4 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10/arm
- 15sec Single Leg Wall Sit/leg
- 15sec Planche Lean
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8
4 Sets
- 15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge R
- 15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge L
- 15sec Star Plank R
- 15sec Star Plank L
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):
30 min Mobility
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min

2. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
3. Wrist Circles x 10
4. Downdog to Updog x 5
5. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
6. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
7. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
8. Crab Reach x 5/side
9. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
10. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
11. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
12. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
13. Reverse Nordics x 10

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip Progression
This is the last dip session, done in a descending 5, 3, 2 rep format, with the effort climbing across the six sets. The first three sets set a moderate baseline, then the last three push into heavier or harder territory. As the reps drop, make the dips harder by adding weight or using less assistance. This is your heaviest dip work of the whole cycle.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
3. Prone Shoulder CARs; 5 SLOW reps
4. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your dips harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging dips. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 6 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean Away DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
6-10 Hand Release T Push Up
8-12 Dual DB Hang Snatch 50/35# or 35/20# (Male/Female)
Row 250/200m
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest to a minimum throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Walking Lunge
This is the final suitcase walking lunge of the cycle. Reps drop to six per side, so this should be your heaviest lunge work of the block. With a dumbbell in each hand at your sides, your grip and

upper back have to work to keep you tall under the heavier load. Keep your torso upright and aim to beat Week 4 on every working set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
3. DB Lateral Lunge; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 4-6 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
200m Run
10 Russian Step Up (5/side) 24/20" (Male/Female)
15 Russian KBS
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output per set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
This is the last low incline dumbbell bench of the cycle. The slight incline keeps the work on your mid and upper chest while the dumbbells stay easy on your shoulders. Reps drop again this week, so this should be your heaviest dumbbell pressing of the block. Aim to beat Week 4 across all your working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworms
1min Plank DB Pull Through 50/35# (Male/Female)
15 Tall Kneeling Crush Grip Hammer Curls 50/35#
1 min Farmers Walk
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Back Squat Progression
The back squat completes the cycle at 15 reps per set, the highest rep count of the block. High rep squats test your legs and your ability to keep pushing when tired. Brace hard at the top of every rep before you drop. The goal is the same depth and speed on rep fifteen as on rep one.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
12 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
12/9 Calorie Row (Male/Female)
6 Goblet Squat
rest 30 sec
18 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
18/14 Calorie Row
9 Goblet Squat
rest 30 sec
24 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
24/18 Calorie Row
12 Goblet Squat
rest 30 sec
30 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
30/24 Calorie Row
15 Goblet Squat
*15 min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
30 min Mobility
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
2. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
3. Wrist Circles x 10
4. Downdog to Updog x 5
5. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
6. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
7. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
8. Crab Reach x 5/side
9. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
10. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
11. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
12. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
13. Reverse Nordics x 10

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Strict Bar Dip Progression
This is the last dip session, done in a descending 5, 3, 2 rep format with effort climbing across the six sets. The first three sets set a moderate baseline, then the last three push into heavier or harder territory. As the reps drop, make the dips harder by adding weight or using less assistance. This is your heaviest dip work of the whole cycle.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
3. Prone Shoulder CARs; 5 SLOW reps
4. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your dips harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging dips. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
6-10 Hand Release T Push Up
8-12 Dual DB Hang Snatch 50/35# or 35/20# (Male/Female)
Row 250/200m
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:

Deficit Deadlift
This is the last deadlift of the cycle. Standing on the plate makes you reach farther to the bar, so your hamstrings and glutes work hardest right at the start of the pull. Reps are at their lowest this week, so this should be your heaviest pulling of the whole block. Brace hard, keep the bar tight to your body, and aim to beat Week 4.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
3. DB Lateral Lunge; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 4-6 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
200m Run
10 Russian Step Up (5/side) 24/20" (Male/Female)
15 Russian KB Swings

rest 90 sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Upper Body Mobility
1. Shoulder Circles x 5/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
3. Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
4. Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
5. Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
6. Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
7. Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
8. Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
9. Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
10. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
11. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
12. Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat completes the cycle at 15 reps per set, the highest rep count of the block. High rep squats test your legs and your ability to keep pushing when tired. Brace hard at the top of every rep before you drop. The goal is the same depth and speed on rep fifteen as on rep one.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
6-10 Hand Release T Push Up

8-12 Dual Dumbbell Hang Snatch 50/35# or 35/20# Male/Female)
Row 250/200m
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
30 min Full Body Mobility
1. Neck Cars x 3/side
2. Segmented Cat/Cow x 5-10
3. Passive Hang x 1 min
4. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
5. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
6. Shoulder Circles x 5/side
7. Wrist Stretch Extension Stretch + Wrist Isometrics
8. Bretzel Stretch
9. Lumbar Roll to Pike
10. Lumbar Roll to Pancake
11. Pancake 3 way 1 min each direction
12. Cobra 5 x 5 sec
13. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press Progression
This is the last low incline dumbbell bench of the cycle. The slight incline keeps the work on your mid and upper chest while the dumbbells stay easy on your shoulders. Reps drop again this week, so this should be your heaviest dumbbell pressing of the block. Aim to beat Week 4 across all your working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Dumbbell External Rotation on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):
3 Sets
12 Towel KB Curl
rest 15sec
12/side Alternating KB Gorilla Row

rest 15sec
6-8 KB Deadlift + 200ft KB Farmers Walk + 6-8 KB Deadlift
rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 26-35lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.
Effort Note:
Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
4. Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Deficit Deadlift Progression
This is the last deadlift of the cycle. Standing on the plate makes you reach farther to the bar, so your hamstrings and glutes work hardest right at the start of the pull. Reps are at their lowest this

week, so this should be your heaviest pulling of the whole block. Brace hard, keep the bar tight to your body, and aim to beat Week 4.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
3. Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
200m Run
10 Russian Step Up (5/side) 24/20" (Male/Female)
15 Russian KB Swings

rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Upper Body Mobility
1. Shoulder Circles x 5/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
3. Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
4. Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
5. Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
6. Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
7. Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
8. Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
9. Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
10. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
11. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
12. Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus

Perform

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Deficit Deadlift
The final deficit deadlift of the cycle. Reps are at their lowest this week, so this should be the heaviest pulling work of the six weeks. Brace hard, keep the bar tight to the body, and hold your position through the whole pull. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Run Mix Modal based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
1. Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 90 sec x 8 sets
1 Full Snatch
rest until the next 90 sec
Sets 1-3: Easy
Sets 4-6: Moderate
Sets 7-8: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

F) Run Mix Modal (12 min):
12 min SUSTAINED PACE
100m Run
5 Strict Toes to Bar
10 Alternating DB Power Clean 70/50# (Male/Female)
Effort Note: To maximize the total reps during the 12 minutes, perform at a sustainable pace. Start smooth; at about 4 minutes start to pick up the pace if you are feeling great.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press Progression
The final low incline dumbbell bench of the cycle. Reps are at their lowest this week, so this should be your heaviest dumbbell pressing of the block. The slight incline keeps the work on the upper chest while the dumbbells stay easy on the shoulders. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Upper Intervals based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds

1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Dumbbell External Rotation on Knee; 10 reps/side
1. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) HS HOT START (12 min):
Every 3 min x 4 Sets
15' HS Walk or 5 Strict HSPU or 5 Inchworm Push Up
4 Hand Release Burpees
Row 18/15 Cals (Male/Female)
4 Hand Release Burpees
15' HS Walk or 5 Strict HSPU or 5 Inchworm Push Up

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Upper Intervals (12 min):
3 sets
AMRAP 1 min - Double Unders or Single Unders
AMRAP 1 min - Bike for Max Calories
AMRAP 1 min - Pike Leg Lift Over
rest 1 min between sets

Effort Note: The goal here is to challenge local muscle endurance. Take short breaks before you hit failure so that you can maximize the number of reps within the minute. Try to not take more than 10 seconds break during any minute.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
1. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
1. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat Progression
The final back squat of the cycle at fifteen reps per set, the highest rep count of the block. High rep squats test the legs and the will to keep pushing when tired. Brace hard at the top of every rep and hold the same depth and speed on rep fifteen as on rep one. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Lower Sprint based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00-3:00 x 5 sets
1 Power Clean + 1 Hang Clean + 2 Box Jump Clear the Box

rest until next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Lower Sprint (10 min):
Every 2:30 x 5 sets
16 Toes to Bar OR Hanging Knee Tucks
16 DB Suitcase Jump Lunge 35/20# (Male/Female)
20 sec Row SPRINT
rest until the start of the next 2:30
Effort Note: Use the following guide to approach each set with escalating effort on the Row.
Set 1 - Moderate Effort - RPE 7-8
Set 2 - Hard Effort - RPE 8-9
Sets 3-5 - Maximal Effort - RPE 9-10

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
1. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60 sec Moderate
Walk 30 sec
x 8
4 Sets:
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10/arm
- 15 sec Single Leg Wall Sit/leg
- 15 sec Planche Lean
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60 sec Moderate
Walk 30 sec
x 8
4 Sets:
- 15 sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge R
- 15 sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge L
- 15 sec Star Plank R
- 15 sec Star Plank L
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60 sec Moderate
Walk 30 sec
x 8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):
Full Mobility
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
1. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
1. Wrist Circles x 10
1. Downdog to Updog x 5
1. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold
1. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
1. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
1. Crab Reach x 5/side
1. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
1. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
1. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
1. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
1. Reverse Nordics x 10

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip Progression
The final dip session of the cycle in a cluster format, resting seventy five seconds between short heavy sets. Descending reps within each cluster let you handle the hardest dips of the block by adding weight or dropping assistance. Keep every rep strict and full depth even as the load climbs. This should be your heaviest dip work of the six weeks.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Push Pull based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
1. Prone Shoulder CARs; 5 SLOW reps
1. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps

C) KB HOT START (10 min):
3-4 sets
15/12 Cal Row
2 Single Arm KB Sumo Deadlift R
2 Single Arm KB Snatch from Floor R
2 Single Arm Russian Swing R
2 Single Arm KB Snatch R
2 Single Arm KB Sumo Deadlift L
2 Single Arm KB Snatch from Floor L
2 Single Arm Russian Swing L
2 Single Arm KB Snatch L
rest 30 sec between sets

D) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note: As reps go down, make your dips harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging dips. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 6 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean Away DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12 min Continuous Clock
4-6 Ring Muscle Up
8-12 DB Push Press 50/35# (Male/Female)
Row 250/200m
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Walking Lunge Progression
The final suitcase walking lunge of the cycle. Reps are at their lowest this week, so this should be the heaviest single leg work of the six weeks. Grip a heavy dumbbell in each hand, use straps as needed, and keep each step controlled and tall. Aim to beat Week 4 across all working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power 30 based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
1. DB Lateral Lunge; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 4-6 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Power 30 (30 min):
Part 1 — For Time @ Tough Effort (7 min Cap)
15-25 Cal Row
15 Box Jump Over 24/20" (Male/Female)
30 Hang Power Snatch 75/55#
15 Box Jump Over 24/20"
15-25 Cal Row
Effort Note: These Time Caps are intentionally challenging. Work hard to try and get your time under this number, but by no means get down if you don't. You will get a minimum of 3 minutes rest before part 2 regardless. Adjust the barbell weight as needed dependent on your comfort level with this movement.
Part 2 — Beginning at 10 min on the clock, Every 5 min x 4 Sets:
12-15 Russian KBS (70/53#)
12-15 Goblet Box Step Up (70/53#)
12-15 Cal Row
12-20 Wall Balls (20/14, 10'/9')
*rest the remainder of the time before the next 5 min period

Effort Note: Try to keep your times between 2:30-3:30 for each set. If you are taking longer then drop the reps. The KB weight should allow you to perform each set unbroken; adjust accordingly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
1. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Perform

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, September 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
This is the last low incline dumbbell bench of the cycle. The slight incline keeps the work on your mid and upper chest while the dumbbells stay easy on your shoulders. Reps drop again this week, so this should be your heaviest dumbbell pressing of the block. Aim to beat Week 4 across all your working sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
1. Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Filly Press; 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworms
1min Plank DB Pull Through 50/35# (Male/Female)
15 Tall Kneeling Crush Grip Hammer Curls 50/35#
1 min Farmers Walk
Effort Note: Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section, the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side

1. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
1. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Tuesday, September 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Goblet Squat Progression
The goblet squat completes the cycle at 20 reps per set, the highest rep count of the block. High rep squats test your legs and your ability to keep pushing when tired. Brace hard at the top of every rep before you drop. The goal is the same depth and speed on rep twenty as on rep one.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Hamstring to Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Flow; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 20 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 20 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 20 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Clamshell Side Plank Hip Thrust; 8-12 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
12 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
12 Burpee
12 Squat Jumps
rest 30sec
18 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
18 Burpee
18 Squat Jumps
rest 30sec
24 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
24 Burpee
24 Squat Jumps
rest 30sec
30 Pike Leg Lift Overs (R+L = 1)
30 Burpee
30 Squat Jumps
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note: This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
1. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, September 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):
30 min Mobility
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
1. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
1. Wrist Circles x 10

1. Downdog to Updog x 5
1. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
1. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
1. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
1. Crab Reach x 5/side
1. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
1. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
1. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
1. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
1. Reverse Nordics x 10

Thursday, October 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Strict Pull Up
Your pulling strength runs as a mechanical drop set this cycle, so you keep training the back after your hardest position gives out. Start with pronated strict pull ups at a 21X1 tempo, using only as much assistance as you need to hit the reps clean, then move straight into the DB gorilla row to keep loading once the overhand grip is spent. Reps on the pull up drop to six this week, the lowest of the block, so this is your heaviest and most honest pulling. Stay strict with no kip and squeeze your shoulder blades down and back on every rep.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
1. Prone Shoulder CARs; 5 SLOW reps
1. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo

rest 15 sec

2. DB Gorilla Row; 20 reps (R+L=2) @30X0 Tempo

rest 2 minutes

Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 6 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean Away DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
6-10 Hand Release T Push Up
8-12 Dual DB Hang Snatch 50/35# or 35/20# (Male/Female)
Run 200m
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, October 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Split Stance DB RDL
This is the final RDL of the cycle, and reps climb to eight per side, the most single leg hinging you have done in the block. The split stance drives the load into the front hamstring and glute while the back leg only helps you balance. Push the front hip straight back, keep the dumbbells close and your back flat, and stand tall with a glute squeeze at the top. Hold a steady weight across all three sets and make every rep smooth and controlled.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets

1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
1. DB Lateral Lunge; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance DB RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 4-6 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
200m Run
10 Russian Step Up (5/side)
30 Mountain Climbers (15/side)
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note: Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
1. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, October 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Upper Body Mobility
1. Shoulder Circles x 5/side
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
1. Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
1. Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
1. Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
1. Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
1. Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold

1. Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
1. Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
1. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
1. Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, October 4th, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

Training Myth: Cardio kills your gains

There's this idea that any aerobic work will eat away at your muscle and strength, so lifters avoid it entirely. But here's what actually happens when you build a solid aerobic base. You recover faster between sets. Your heart rate comes down quicker, you can push your next set harder, and you can handle more total training volume across a session without breaking down. That's not working against your gains, that's supporting them. Cardio isn't the enemy of strength, undervaluing your engine is. A stronger aerobic base makes you a better lifter, not a smaller one.

Warmly, Marcus